

BEST CEOs

**MANISH
SATYANARAYAN
NUWAL**
PILLARS OF PROGRESS

A NEW-FOUND AGGRESSION

Manish Satyanarayan Nuwal is turning Solar Industries from a maker of explosives for mining to a serious player in the promising defence market

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**

138 |

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MANISH SATYANARAYAN NUWAL laughs when you ask if playing with fire is fun. His Nagpur-headquartered Solar Industries has been in the business of making explosives for more than two decades.

But that was not how it all started. From humble origins in a small town in Rajasthan

to dabbling in various ventures, including ink manufacturing, his father, Satyanarayan Nuwal zeroed in on explosives in the early 1980s, first as a trader. In 1996, he moved into manufacturing bulk and packaged explosives, detonators, detonating chords and initiating systems. The company catered to a host of industries, including mining, infrastructure and construction, through plants housed in India and overseas. Manish joined the company in the mid-nineties.

In 2010, Solar Industries moved into the defence sector for its next phase of growth. Initially, though, growth in defence was hard to come by, and there were a host of apprehensions. During the testing phase, money in the form of capex had already been put in and the manufacturing capacity was in place. However, orders were elusive. “We did the right things and participated in many development

